



A still from the S.S. Rajamouli-directed blockbuster *RRR*. The director says technology should be just a tool for film-makers

nology but using it is where your skill lies. Storytellers must understand this well and in a changing India that is a critical element. At the end of the day, both are used to convey emotions effectively. If a film-maker uses technology with the idea of impressing his audience, he is going down the wrong path. The audience comes for the human emotion and will always continue to do so.

Nothing over the next 25 years will make me happier than India becoming a force to reckon with in the global film arena. Today, that is dominated by Hollywood, China and Korea. Yes, we do make a large number of films but the global impact is limited. That should and must change. Let's be clear on no limit existing in India for either potential or opportunity. The question is—do we have the attitude?

The size of the audience, too, has changed beyond recognition. As a film-maker, I always had the ambition to reach out to all Indians. The hurdles that came in the way of this were distribution and marketing but never the story. With time, my producers were able to crack these challenges. I moved from an audience in Telugu to Tamil before getting the whole of India to watch my films. What was most unexpected remains the connection the West made with *RRR*. To say, it was a pleasant surprise is a complete understatement.

The issue of disruption needs to be spoken about. It is something that has affected industries and will continue to do so with the passage of time. There is no doubt that the process will change but the requirements of the individual human being will not change and that is

with respect to listening to a story. How he wants to experience that will definitely change and we must adapt to it. Change could come like a tsunami or it may be slow but it is inevitable. It is left to us how well we can adapt to it. Both the storyteller and the ones who listen to the story will remain. Making it relevant in the midst of change is a challenge we must address.

I understand how the global audience has opened up for me with *RRR*. But if I try to do something different, that might not work. It is my responsibility to constantly upgrade myself and just better what I have done. However, I cannot take my eyes off the basics and that comes down to storytelling in a new India. **BT**

*As told to Krishna Gopalan.
Rajamouli is a film-maker*